9.13 Osteomyelitis*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My leg is painful and I have fever." **Objective** • Local swelling and warmth • Temperature 38.5 °C • Raised CRP	**ACTUAL** Acute pain related to bone infection as evidenced by localized pain and swelling.	• Pain at or below 3/10 within 48 hours.	• Immobilize the limb. • Give analgesia as prescribed. • Elevate the limb.	• Considered met when pain is controlled.
Subjective • "I feel hot and shivery." **Objective** • Temperature 38.5 °C • Raised CRP	**ACTUAL** Hyperthermia related to infection as evidenced by a temperature of 38.5 °C.	• Afebrile within 72 hours of antibiotics.	• Give the long IV antibiotic course on time. • Check drug levels as ordered.	• Goal reached once afebrile.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Weakened bone • Tibial infection	**RISK** Risk for physical injury as evidenced by risk factors: pathological fracture of infected bone.	• No pathological fracture.	• Handle the limb gently. • Keep to the weight-bearing limits. • Provide walking aids.	• Met if no fracture occurs.

* **References for this care plan:** [32], [35], [37]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.